Gihun Im

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Student in Counseling Psychology Aug 2024 – Present
The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA, United States
Advisor: Amanda S. Case, Ph.D.
GPA: 4.22

M.A. in Educational Counseling Mar 2022 – Feb 2024
Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea
Advisor: Dongil Kim, Ph.D.
Thesis: Korean school counselors' counseling competencies and advocacy activities for LGBTQ+ youth: A latent profile analysis
GPA: 4.26

B.A. in English Education & B.A. in Psychology Mar 2011 – Feb 2018
Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea, *dual degree*
GPA: 4.14, *Magna Cum Laude*

PROFESSIONAL AND CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Special Graduate Assistant Aug 2026 – Present
Iowa Testing Programs, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Amanda S. Case, Ph.D.
- Selected as the department's recipient based on outstanding potential
- Coordinate research, program development, and knowledge translation across multiple initiatives, including NPEA and community-based college success projects

Counseling Psychology Trainee Aug 2026 – Present
Holden Comprehensive Cancer Center, University of Iowa Health Care
Supervisor: Gregory L. Gullickson, Ph.D.
- Provide brief individual therapy to patients diagnosed with cancer

Research Assistant Nov 2025 – May 2026
Department of Counselor Education, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Isak Kim, Ph.D.
- Coordinated counseling research projects involving IRB protocol development, Qualtrics survey design, and participant recruitment
- Analyzed large-scale data sets (e.g., Healthy Minds Study) and contributed to manuscript preparation
- Contributed to internal and external grant applications focused on counselor training, digital mental health, and underserved populations

Graduate Research Assistant Mar 2025 – May 2026
Telepsychology Training Clinic, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Martin Kivlighan, Ph.D.
- Managed administrative tasks related to clinic operations
- Maintained connections with community resources to support rural mental health
- Coordinated workshops and outreach activities

Doctoral Trainee Aug 2024 – May 2026
University Counseling Service, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Patrick Galligan, Ph.D.
- Provide brief individual therapy for undergraduate and graduate students
- Conduct initial consultation and single-session intervention
- Engage in outreach activities to promote campus mental health awareness
- Facilitate group therapy

Graduate Research Assistant Aug 2024 – May 2025
Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Julie M. Koch, Ph.D.
- Conducted literature reviews and preliminary regression analyses examining LGBTQ+ mental health outcomes within interdisciplinary research collaborations
- Conducted literature reviews and developed practice guideline outlines for therapists working in international and LGBTQ+-neutral contexts
- Supported ongoing research and departmental scholarly initiatives
- Assisted the department coordinator with administrative tasks

Certified School Counselor Mar 2024 – Aug 2024
Dangsan Middle School, *Full-time*
- Provided individual/group counseling for middle school students (450+ students)
- Delivered social-emotional learning (SEL) and anti-bullying programs

Intern Counselor Mar 2022 – Feb 2024
SNU Center for Campus Life & Culture, Seoul National University
- Provided counseling and performed psychological assessments for undergraduate and graduate students
- Led and co-led group counseling programs

Research Assistant Mar 2022 – Feb 2024
Department of Education, Seoul National University
Supervisor: Dongil Kim, Ph.D.
- Conducted quantitative and qualitative research on LGBTQ+ mental health, counselor training, career development, and youth intervention programs
- Utilized diverse methodologies, including structural equation modeling (SEM), factor analysis, latent class and profile analysis (LCA/LPA), mediation/moderation modeling, Delphi methods, focus group interviews (FGIs), thematic analysis, consensual qualitative research (CQR), and program evaluation
- Supported research dissemination through manuscript preparation, conference presentations, literature reviews, survey development, and data analysis

Certified School Counselor Mar 2019 – Feb 2022
Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education (headquarters), *Full-time*
- Contributed to creating government policies and guidelines for the school counseling system in Seoul
- Developed counseling and guidance programs for 1,300+ school counseling offices (*Wee Class*) and 26 centers (*Wee Center*) in Seoul
- Implemented crisis intervention programs and conducted counseling services for both students and staff members impacted by traumatic events (7 different occasions)
- Provided psychological consulting as a consultant to school staff members and caregivers
- Offered counseling services to students with mental, academic, and/or developmental issues
- Delivered anti-bullying programs as a lecturer for students who have engaged in school violence, as well as their caregivers

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant Fall 2026
PSQF:6223 Introduction to Counseling Psychology Practice/Research
Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa
- Facilitate class discussions and deliver instruction on various topics in counseling psychology

Guest Lecturer Spring 2026
CSED:6353 Pre-Practicum & Case Management in Counseling
Department of Counselor Education, University of Iowa

Teaching Assistant Spring 2026
PSQF:7310 Intelligence Assessment
Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa
- Scored assignments and provided feedback on intelligence assessment administrations (WAIS-5, WISC-5, WIAT-4, NEPSY-II, D-KEFS, SB-5, BASC-2)

PUBLICATIONS

[KCI] denotes the Korean Citation Index, indicating that the article is in Korean.

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

6. Kim, I., **Im, G.**, Min, Y., & Ding, R. (in press). Ambivalent engagement with generative AI: Greater mental health use and concern among college students with anxiety-depression. *Journal of American College Health*.
5. **Im, G.**, & Kim, D. (in press). Korean school counselors' counseling competencies and advocacy activities for LGBTQ+ youth: A latent profile analysis. *Current Psychology*.
4. **Im, G.** (2026). Ethical risk prevention in client generative artificial intelligence (genAI) use: Applying the primary risk-management model. *American Psychologist*, *81*(7), 1048–1059. https://doi.org/10.1037/amp0001731
3. Kim, D., **Im, G.**, Chung, G., & Park, J. (2025). Impact of discussion activity in international youth exchange programs on global citizenship: Mediating role of multicultural competence. *Journal of Education & Culture*, *31*(1), 597–613. [KCI]
2. Kim, D., Park, J., & **Im, G.** (2025). Research on developing a social enrichment program for young adults with borderline intellectual functioning. *Disability & Employment*, *35*(1), 163–186. [KCI]
1. Kim, D., Park, J., Lee, J., Park, I., & **Im, G.** (2023). Exploring subjects of standardized curriculum for youth counselors in South Korea by Delphi method. *Studies on Korean Youth*, *34*(4), 141–162. [KCI]

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

3. **Im, G.** (under review). Outing-related threat and depression among sexual minority adults during the COVID-19 pandemic: Internalized homophobia and the dual role of community connectedness.
2. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (under review). A systematic review and meta-synthesis on LGBTQ+ partner bereavement: Grief trajectories toward an ecological framework.
1. **Im, G.**, Case, A. S., Bae, I., Ji, S., Tang, Y., & Zhang, Y. (under review). User engagement with ChatGPT for mental health support: A mixed-method meta-analysis.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

3. **Im, G.**, Jun, E., Yoon, H., & Case, A. S. (in preparation). LGBTQ+ educators in South Korea: A photovoice study on marginalization, resilience, and advocacy.
2. Park, E., Lazo-Salmeron, W., **Im, G.**, Jensen, S., Perez, J. A., & Zoet, Z. (in preparation). Understanding the lived experiences of scientist practitioner advocates: An interpretative phenomenological analysis.
1. Bae, I., & **Im, G.** (in preparation). Relationship between decent education and decent work for youth: Mediating effects of work volition and career adaptability.

RESEARCH GRANTS

2. **Lee Chang Kook Fund: Queer Research Grant** Aug 2025 – Aug 2026
   Beyond the Rainbow Foundation
   LGBTQ+ educators in South Korea: A photovoice study
   Principal Investigator
   $1,200

1. **Mary Bywater Cross and Robert P. Newman Research Award** Oct 2024 – May 2025
   College of Education, University of Iowa
   The relationship between perceived threat of COVID-19, internalized stigma, and depression among LGB individuals: Moderated mediating role of community connectedness
   Principal Investigator
   $1,000

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

13. **Im, G.**, Case, A. S., Bae, I., Ji, S., Tang, Y., & Zhang, Y. (2026, August 6–8). *User engagement with ChatGPT for mental health support: A mixed-method meta-analysis* [Poster presentation]. Division 17 Student Poster Session, APA 2026 Annual Convention, Washington, DC, United States.

12. Zoet, Z., **Im, G.**, Lazo-Salmeron, W., Karimzadeh, L., Park, E., Jensen, S., Clarke, W. F., Perez, J., & Campos, D. (2026, August 6–8). *Critical reflections & action: Moving values from theory to practice* [Invited address]. APA 2026 Annual Convention, Washington, DC, United States.

11. **Im, G.** (2026, August 6–8). *Ethical risk prevention in client generative AI use: Applying the primary risk-management model* [Poster presentation]. APA 2026 Convention, Washington, DC, United States.

10. Zhang, Y., Ben, L., **Im, G.**, & Tang, Y. (2026, February 26–28). *How counselors navigate religious/spiritual value conflict in counseling: A scoping review* [Poster presentation]. SPSP 2026 Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.

9. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (2025, August 7–9). *A decade later: Revisiting LGBTQ+ partner loss and bereavement in the post-same-sex marriage era* [Poster presentation]. APA 2025 Convention, Denver, CO, United States.

8. Tang, Y., **Im, G.**, & Zhang, Y. (2025, August 7–9). *Community efforts in promoting youth resilience: A systematic review of community-based intervention* [Poster presentation]. APA 2025 Convention, Denver, CO, United States.

7. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (2025, July 11). *A decade later: Revisiting LGBTQ+ partner loss and bereavement in the post-same-sex marriage era* [Paper presentation]. 2025 Korean Association for LGBTQ+ and Queer Studies, Seoul, South Korea.

6. Ko, J., Park, J., **Im, G.**, Cheung, S., & Reid-Marks, L. (2024, August 8–10). *Social stigma, social status, work volition, social support, and positive identity in LGB college students in Korea* [Poster presentation]. APA 2024 Convention, Seattle, WA, United States.

5. Koch, J. M., Shin, Y.-J., Lee, J., & **Im, G.** (2024, July 21–26). *Affirmative psychological practice in LGBTQ-neutral countries* [Poster presentation]. The 33rd International Congress of Psychology, Prague, Czech Republic.

4. Bae, I., & **Im, G.** (2024, June 5). *Relationships between decent education and decent work for youth: Mediating effects of work volition and career adaptability* [Paper presentation]. 2024 Employment Survey Conference, Seoul, South Korea.

3. **Im, G.** (2024, July 19). *Relationships between perceived threat of COVID-19, internalized stigma, and depression among LGB people: Focusing on the moderating effects of community connectedness* [Paper presentation]. The 1st Conference of Junior Scholars Network of LGBTIQ Research, Seoul, South Korea.

2. **Im, G.** (2023, October 11–13). *Overcoming the limitations of school-based suicide post interventions: Focusing on the experiences of key staff members of "Wee Center"* [Poster presentation]. The 23rd International Conference of Educational Research, Seoul, South Korea.

1. Yoon-Lee, S., & **Im, G.** (2023, October 1–31). *"Are we on the same page?": The critical autoethnography of Korean queer counselors* [Paper presentation]. Society for Sexual, Affectional, Intersex, and Gender Expressive Identities (SAIGE) 2023 Virtual Conference.

SCHOLARSHIPS, FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND HONORS

Audrey Qualls Travel Award 2025, 2026
College of Education, University of Iowa

Office of the Dean Graduate Student Travel Award 2025, 2026
College of Education, University of Iowa

Graduate Tuition Scholarship 2025
College of Education, University of Iowa

Distinguished Student Research Award 2024
Korea Employment Information Service

Semester High Honors 2023
College of Education, Seoul National University

Brain Korea 21 (BK-21) Plus Scholarship 2022, 2023
Seoul National University

Superintendent's Citation of Merit 2021
Seoul Metropolitan Superintendent of Education

Scholarship for CAU Alumni Association 2017
Chung-Ang University Alumni Association

Semester High Honors 2017
College of Education, Chung-Ang University

Mentorship Grant 2016
Korea Foundation for the Advancement of Science and Creativity (KOFAC)

National Scholarship 2012 – 2017
Korea Student Aid Foundation

LEADERSHIP, SERVICE, AND RELATED EXPERIENCE

ADVOCACY & ACTIVISM

Operational Board Jul 2022 – Present
The EE-MM: Network for Queer and Transgender Counselors in Korea

Junior Ombudsperson May 2022 – Aug 2022
SNU Human Rights Center, Seoul National University

Certified Teacher Member Feb 2020 – Present
LGBTQ Youth Crisis Support Center "Ddingdong", Seoul, South Korea

Chairperson Sep 2015 – Feb 2016
QUV: Solidarity of University Queer Societies in Korea

President Mar 2015 – Feb 2016
LGBTQ+ Student Club "Rainbow Fish", Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea

Leadership & Professional Service

International Committee Co-Chair Aug 2025 – Present
Student Affiliates of Seventeen (SAS) Executive Board, APA Division 17
- Lead the International Committee in developing initiatives that support the professional development of international counseling psychology students
- Collaborate with the Executive Board to integrate international perspectives into SAS programming and advocacy efforts

Advisory Board May 2019 – Feb 2021
National Human Rights Commission of the Republic of Korea

Editorial Committee May 2020 – Nov 2020
Task Force for School Counseling System (*Wee Project*), Korea Educational Development Institute (KEDI)

Editorial Service

Ad Hoc Reviewer
Journal of Prevention & Health Promotion 2026 – Present
Translational Issues in Psychological Science 2026 – Present
Psychology of Sexual Orientation and Gender Diversity 2026 – Present
Current Psychology 2026 – Present

Community Service

Instructor May 2026 – Jul 2026
Every Underachieving Student Succeeds Program, Seoul National University

Program Facilitator Jun 2023 – Jul 2023
Global Youth Summit, The National Council of Youth Organizations in Korea

Instructor May 2022 – Jul 2022
Every Underachieving Student Succeeds Program, Seoul National University

Teaching Intern Jul 2016 – Dec 2016
Korea Foundation for the Advancement of Science and Creativity (KOFAC)

Teaching Staff Jul 2013 – Aug 2014
Pyeongtaek Regional Support Center for Children, Gyeonggi-do, South Korea

Extracurricular Activities

Student Reporter Jul 2015 – Dec 2015
Editorial Team, Daehaknaeil, South Korea

Military Service

Legal Assistant Aug 2012 – Aug 2014
Legal Office, Air Force Operations Command, Gyeonggi-do, South Korea

SKILLS

Language: Korean (native), English (fluent), Japanese (working proficiency)
Statistical Programs: SPSS (PROCESS macro), AMOS, M*plus*, R, jamovi and STATA

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Counselor, Korean Psychological Association (KPA) 2023
Survey Analyst, Human Resources Development Service of Korea 2021
Certified School Counselor, Korean Ministry of Education *(National Teacher Certification)* 2018
Certified Secondary English Teacher, Korean Ministry of Education 2018

PROFESSIONAL/COMMUNITY AFFILIATIONS

American Psychological Association
  Division 17, Society of Counseling Psychology
  Division 44, Society for the Psychology of Sexual Orientation and Gender Diversity
Korean Psychological Association
  Division 2, Korean Counseling Psychology Association
Korean Counseling Association (KCA)
  KCA-International Chapter
Korean Association for LGBTQ+ and Queer Studies
Korean Psychology Network
LGBTQ Youth Crisis Support Center “Ddingdong”
The EE-MM: Network for Queer and Transgender Counselors in Korea

REFERENCES

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